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Silicon dunes

硅丘

War has not **halted** the Gulf's data-centre boom
战争未能阻挡海湾地区的数据中心热潮

难度评级：★★★★☆

【 Para.1 】

Soon after war **broke out** in the Gulf, Iranian **drones** targeted Amazon's data centres in the United Arab Emirates (UAE) and Bahrain. But at Stargate UAE, a 1-**gigawatt** data centre being built on a 5GW campus in Abu Dhabi, work “never stopped,” says an executive at a state-backed artificial-intelligence firm. The first 200-megawatt phase is almost complete.

海湾地区战事爆发后不久，伊朗无人机便将亚马逊位于阿联酋(UAE)和巴林的数据中心列为打击目标。但在“星际之门阿联酋”(Stargate UAE)，据一位某国资人工智能公司的高管表示，建设工作“从未停止”。该在建项目位于阿布扎比一个 5 吉瓦园区内，落成后会是一座 1 吉瓦数据中心。目前首期 200 兆瓦阶段已接近完工。

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文章导读：

海湾地区地缘局势动荡，但当地数据中心建设持续推进，多家企业加码布局，美国头部云厂商也积极与阿联酋开展合作。低廉的土地与能源、充足资本、AI 人才流入、宽松的公众舆论环境，叠加相关政策支持，共同推动建设热潮。地缘冲突虽冲击当地经济，却也促使当地着力保障数字领域投资。

dune n. /du:n/ a small hill of sand formed by the wind, near the sea or in a desert (风吹积成的) 沙丘

halt v. to stop; to make sb/sth stop (使) 停止，停下 【**考研英语大纲词汇**】

The trial was **halted** after the first week. 第一周结束后，审判暂停。

break out phrase if something such as war, fighting, or disease breaks out, it begins suddenly (战争、殴斗、疾病等) 爆发

He was 29 when war **broke out**. 战争爆发时他29岁。

drone n. /drɒn/ an aircraft without a pilot, controlled from the ground 无人驾驶飞机

gigawatt n. /'gɪɡəˌwɒt/ 吉瓦，千兆瓦，十亿瓦特

fourfold adv. /'fɔːfəʊld/ by or up to four times as many or as much 四倍地

sovereign-wealth fund n. /'sɒvrɪn/ a state-owned investment fund 主权财富基金(一种国家拥有的投资基金)

outfit n. /'aʊtfɪt/ a group of people working together as an organization, business, team, etc. 团队；小组；分队 【**考研英语大纲词汇**】

a market research **outfit** 市场调查组

trumpet v. /'trʌmpɪt/ ~ sth (as sth) to talk about sth publicly in a proud or enthusiastic way 宣扬；鼓吹；吹嘘 【**考研英语大纲词汇**】

to **trumpet sb's achievements** 吹嘘某人的成就

hyperscaler n. /'hɪpərˌskeɪlər/ 超大规模云服务商：指拥有极大规模的数据中心和基础设施，能够向客户提供海量算力、存储及云服务的顶尖科技巨头

lease v. ~ sth (from sb), ~ sth (out) (to sb) to use or let sb use sth, especially property or equipment, in exchange for rent or a regular payment 租用，租借，出租（尤指房地产或设备） 【**考研英语大纲词汇**】

They **lease** the land from a local farmer. 他们从当地一位农场主手中租得这块土地。

tariff n. /'tærɪf/ a list of fixed prices that are charged by a hotel or restaurant for rooms, meals, etc., or by a company for a particular service (旅馆、饭店或服务公司的) 价目表，收费表 【**考研英语大纲词汇**】

【 Para.2 】

Last year PwC, a consultancy, predicted that across the Gulf data-centre capacity would rise **fourfold** within five years, to about 4GW. The outbreak of war has not halted the boom. HUMAIN, an AI company established by Saudi Arabia's **sovereign-wealth fund**, announced last month that it would build a facility with DataVolt, another Saudi firm, at Oxagon, an industrial city on the country's west coast. Two other Saudi **outfits**, Axelerated Solutions and Al Moammar Information Systems, have also **trumpeted** new data-centre investments.

去年，咨询机构普华永道预测，整个海湾地区的数据中心容量将在五年内扩大至四倍，达到约 4 吉瓦。战事爆发并未遏止这一热潮。由沙特主权财富基金设立的人工智能公司 HUMAIN 上月宣布，将与另一家沙特企业 DataVolt 合作，在沙特西海岸工业城市奥克萨贡共建一座数据中心。另外两家沙特公司 Axelerated Solutions 和 Al Moammar Information Systems，也高调公布了新的数据中心投资。

【 Para.3 】

America's **hyperscalers**, too, seem to have lost none of their enthusiasm. In September Amazon Web Services said it was expanding a partnership with HUMAIN to provide more data-centre capacity by 2028. Last month Microsoft, which has **leased** Saudi sites from Al Moammar and is working with Du, an Emirati telecom firm, to build a data

- well adv.** to a great extent or degree 很；相当；大大地；远远地 【考研大纲词汇】
- a well-loved tale** 深受喜爱的故事
- hub n.** ~ (of sth) the central and most important part of a particular place or activity (某地或活动的) 中心，核心
- inflow n.** the movement of a lot of money, people or things into a place from somewhere else (资金、人或事物的) 流入，涌入 **SYN** influx
- reverse v.** to change sth completely so that it is the opposite of what it was before 颠倒；彻底转变；使完全相反 【考研大纲词汇】
- to reverse a procedure/process/trend** 彻底改变程序/过程/趋势
- deep pocket phrase** a source of substantial wealth (usually plural) 深口袋：拥有大量财力的个人或组织；也可指雄厚的财力或财源
- paymaster n.** a person or group of people that pays another person or organization and therefore can control their actions 操纵者；后台老板
- underwrite v.** to accept financial responsibility for an activity so that you will pay for special costs or for losses it may make 承担经济责任（包括支付特别费用或损失）
The government will have to create a special agency to **underwrite** small business loans. 政府将不得不建立一个专门机构来为小额企业贷款提供担保。
- deploy v.** to move soldiers or weapons into a position where they are ready for military action 部署，调度（军队或武器）
2 000 troops were **deployed** in the area. 那个地区部署了2 000 人的部队。
- sovereignty n.** /'sɒvrənti/ ~ (over sth) complete power to govern a country 主权；最高统治权；最高权威
- build-out phrase** an urban planner's estimate of the amount and location of potential development for an area 增建，扩建
- resent v.** /rɪ'zent/ to feel bitter or angry about sth, especially because you feel it is unfair 愤恨；感到气愤；愤愤不平 【考研大纲词汇】
I deeply **resented** her criticism. 我对她的批评感到非常气愤
- on the/sb's doorstep phrase** very close to where a person lives 在某人的住所旁
The nightlife is great with bars and clubs right **on the doorstep**. 有这些酒吧和夜总会位于家门口，夜生活真是棒极了。
- bash v.** /bæʃ/ to criticize sb/sth strongly 严厉批评
Bashing politicians is normal practice in the press. 严厉批判政治人物乃是新闻界常事。
- craft v.** to make sth using special skills, especially with your hands (尤指用手工) 精心制作 【考研大纲词汇】
All the furniture is **crafted** from natural materials. 所有的家具均采用天然材料精心制作而成。
- embassy n.** /'embəsi/ the building in which an embassy works 大使馆（指馆舍）
- moot v.** /mu:t/ to suggest an idea for people to discuss 提出...供讨论
SYN propose, put forward

centre in the UAE, said it would bring more regional capacity online in November.

美国超大规模云厂商似乎同样热情不减。9月，亚马逊云服务表示，正在扩大与 HUMAN 的合作，以期在 2028 年前提供更多数据中心容量。上月，微软表示将于 11 月启用更多区域容量；该公司已从 Al Moammar 租用沙特站点，并正与阿联酋电信企业 Du 合作，在阿联酋建设数据中心。

【 Para.4 】

Several factors explain the region's continued attraction, despite the conflict. One is cheap energy: electricity **tariffs** in the Gulf are around six cents per kilowatt hour, compared with between nine and 15 cents in America, reports PwC. Vast amounts of renewable power and new transmission infrastructure have pushed costs lower. Another is cheap land: according to PwC, industrial land for data centres in Saudi Arabia costs \$10-50 per square metre, **well** below the \$150-600 in northern Virginia, where many of America's server farms live. McKinsey, another consultancy, puts the cost of building and powering a 100-megawatt AI data centre in the Gulf at \$200-220 per MW hour, nearly as low as in China.

尽管战争冲突持续，该地区仍具吸引力，原因有几点。其一是能源价格低廉：普华永道报告称，海湾地区电价约为每千瓦时 6 美分，而美国为 9 至 15 美分。大量可再生能源和新输电基础设施进一步压低了成本。其二是土地价格低廉：据普华永道数据，沙特数据中心工业用地价格为每平方米 10 至 50 美元，远低于

►今日句子分析

Para 8. What is more, there is little of the public opposition to data centres increasingly on show in the West, where many people resent power-hungry facilities on their doorstep. 更重要的是，西方公众针对数据中心的反对日益显现，许多人对住所附近的高耗能设施感到不满，但这种情况在海湾地区却很少见。

主句

What is more, there is little of the public opposition

(连接性状语) 主语 谓 (真正主语)

to data centres increasingly on show in the West,

定语

定语

定语从句

where many people resent power-hungry facilities

引导词 主语

谓语 宾语

on their doorstep.

状语

主句：

连接性状语-What is more,; 形式主语- there; 谓语- is (there is: 存在句结构)

真正主语，也是真正主语的中心词，表示“几乎没有”，是否定意义-little; 定语，修饰little-of the public opposition; 定语，说明反对对象是数据中心- to data centres;

定语，修饰opposition- increasingly on show in the West (on show “正在上演/展出”整理用来指“(某种现象)正在显现”，例：A tougher Mr Obama may be on show in 2011. 2011年奥巴马可能会显示出更加强硬的态度。)；

定语从句，修饰the West:

引导词-where; 主语- many people; 谓语- resent; 宾语- power-hungry facilities; 状语- on their doorstep.

翻译解析：整体结构可以简化为：There is little of (西方日益显现的那种公众对数据中心的反对)，there指的是前面提到的海湾地区，这里很多同学容易误解为西方很少公众反对，实际上the public opposition...increasingly on show in the West, 西方的反对声音日益增加。如果是西方反对声音少，英文应该是In the West, there is little public opposition.在西方，公众反对很少。

where从句修饰the West, where many people resent power-hungry facilities on their doorstep在西方，许多人对家门口的高耗能设施感到不满。这个从句进一步说明：西方确实存在明显的公众反对。

power-hungry 通常可指人“权欲熏心的”，但这里修饰facilities，意思是“耗电巨大的、电力饥渴的”。

美国北弗吉尼亚州的 150 至 600 美元，美国许多服务器集群便坐落于此。另一家咨询机构麦肯锡估算，在海湾地区建设和供电一座 100 兆瓦人工智能数据中心，成本为每兆瓦时 200 至 220 美元，低到几乎与中国相当。

【 Para.5 】

The Gulf has also established itself as a **hub** for industry talent: last year the UAE and Saudi Arabia were among the countries that recorded the highest net **inflow** of AI workers relative to their workforces. There is no evidence that war has sent this flow of talent into **reverse**.

海湾地区还确立了其行业人才中心的地位：去年，阿联酋和沙特阿拉伯的人工智能人才净流入量（相对于其劳动力规模而言）位于全球前列。而且，目前没有证据表明，战事已使这一人才流入趋势发生逆转。

【 Para.6 】

Then there are the Gulf states' **deep** pockets. In July MGX, an Emirati state-run fund, raised \$50bn to invest in AI. Most of that money will flow to overseas companies, but those wanting a slice of it will be eager to keep their **paymasters** happy by investing in the region.

此外，海湾国家财力雄厚。7月，阿联酋国有基金MGX筹集500亿美元用于投资人工智能。其中大部分资金将流向海外企业，但希望从中分一杯羹的企业，将急于通过在该地区投资来让出资方满意。

➤ 写作积累

Para.4 Several factors explain the region's continued attraction, despite the conflict.

这个句子的写法可以参考，尤其是议论文。相较于 there are several reasons behind...等常见句式，explain 这个动词（解释.....）可以化被动为主动，更简洁地引出下文将要列举的因素，类似例句：scientific findings that help explain the origins of the universe 有助于解释宇宙起源的科学发现。

而后的 despite 则是介词，后可以直接跟名词或动名词，跟 in spite of 几乎可以互用，类似例句：Her voice was shaking despite all her efforts to control it.尽管她竭尽全力控制自己，声音仍然在颤抖。

但需注意 despite 不可直接跟 that 从句，往往会跟名词+同位语从句搭配出现，例如：She was good at physics despite the fact that she found it boring.尽管她认为物理枯燥无味，她却学得很好。

Para.5 The Gulf has also established itself as a hub for industry talent:

establish oneself as 是一个固定搭配，意为“使自己确立为...../使自己成为.....”，例：By then she was established as a star.那时她作为明星的地位已经确立。

后跟的 as 是作为补语存在，引出主语确立的身份/地位。

【 Para.7 】

Domestic policies in the Gulf will require more data centres, in effect **underwriting** demand. In April the UAE said it would **deploy** “agentic AI” across half of the government. The country’s National Cloud Security Policy requires “operational sovereignty” for government entities and operators of critical infrastructure, further supporting the build-out, while Saudi Arabia’s financial institutions are generally required to use cloud services within the country. Luca Bennici of McKinsey notes that private firms in the Gulf have “growing concerns” of their own about data protection and **sovereignty**.

海湾国家的国内政策将需要更多数据中心，这实际上为需求提供了担保。4 月，阿联酋表示将在半数政府部门部署“代理式人工智能”。该国《国家云安全政策》要求政府实体和关键基础设施运营者实现“运营主权”，这进一步支撑了数据中心扩建；沙特阿拉伯的金融机构则普遍被要求使用境内云服务。麦肯锡的卢卡·本尼奇（Luca Bennici）指出，海湾地区私营企业对数据保护和主权问题“的担忧在日益加剧”。

【 Para.8 】

What is more, there is little of the public opposition to data centres increasingly on show in the West, where many people **resent** power-hungry facilities

on their doorstep. **Bashing** data centres has turned into a popular campaign strategy in American politics. In the Gulf, not so much. “Centralised decision making” helps, says an executive in the region.

更重要的是，西方公众针对数据中心的反对日益显现，许多人对住所附近的高耗能设施感到不满，但这种情况在海湾地区却很少见。抨击数据中心已在美国政治成为一种流行的竞选策略。在海湾地区则不然。该地区一位高管表示，这得益于“集中决策”。

【 Para.9 】

True, the war has disrupted the Gulf’s carefully **crafted** economic boom. It has also made the region’s rulers more determined to make their digital investments secure. Kurt Davis junior of Alvarez & Marsal, one more consultancy, notes that plans to make data centres as safe as **embassies**, even putting them underground, are being **mooted**. Nevertheless, the build-out continues.

诚然，战争扰乱了海湾地区精心打造的经济繁荣。但战争也使该地区的执政者更加坚定地要保障其数字投资的安全。另一家咨询机构 Alvarez & Marsal 的小库尔特·戴维斯（Kurt Davis junior）指出，计划将数据中心打造得如使馆般安全、甚至将其设于地下的方案正在酝酿中。尽管如此，数据中心扩建仍在继续。